

COMPLETE REFERENCE & FIELD MANUAL

Elementor Pro

Every element, every backend menu, every setting —
explained for building real WordPress websites.

Covers Elementor Free & Elementor Pro · Editor Interface · Widgets & Elements ·
Theme Builder · Popup Builder · Forms · WooCommerce Builder · Site Settings ·
Custom Code · Role Manager · Performance & Troubleshooting

Table of Contents

1	Introduction to Elementor & Elementor Pro	3
2	Installation, Activation & License	5
3	Touring the Elementor Editor	7
4	The WordPress Backend: Elementor's Admin Menus	9
5	Universal Widget Settings (Content, Style, Advanced)	11
6	Layout Elements: Sections, Columns & Containers	13
7	Free Widget Reference (Basic Elementor)	15
8	Elementor Pro Widget Reference — General & Marketing	17
9	Elementor Pro Widget Reference — Theme Elements	20
10	Theme Builder	22
11	Popup Builder	24
12	Forms: Building, Actions After Submit & Submissions	26
13	WooCommerce Builder & Product Widgets	29
14	Dynamic Tags	31
15	Site Settings (Global Design System)	33
16	Custom Code, Custom Fonts & Custom Icons	35
17	Role Manager & User Permissions	37
18	Elementor Settings, Experiments & Performance	38
19	Maintenance Mode & Coming Soon	41
20	Troubleshooting Quick Reference	42

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Elementor & Elementor Pro

Elementor is a visual, drag-and-drop page builder plugin for WordPress. Elementor Pro is the paid extension that adds advanced widgets, the Theme Builder, Popup Builder, Form Builder, WooCommerce Builder and other production-grade tools on top of the free plugin.

1.1 What Elementor Free Gives You

- A live, front-end visual editor — what you see while editing is what visitors see.
- Basic widgets (Heading, Text Editor, Image, Video, Button, etc.).
- Sections/Columns and Flexbox/Grid Containers for layout.
- A template library of free layout blocks and page kits.
- Responsive editing (desktop, tablet, mobile breakpoints).

1.2 What Elementor Pro Adds

- **40+ additional widgets** — forms, posts, portfolio, sliders, pricing tables, and more.
- **Theme Builder** — design the Header, Footer, Single Post/Page, Archive, Search Results and 404 templates for the whole site, not just individual pages.
- **Popup Builder** — create and trigger popups, hello bars, slide-ins and fly-ins.
- **Form Builder** — multi-field, multi-step forms with email/webhook/CRM actions.
- **WooCommerce Builder** — design shop archives and single product pages visually.
- **Dynamic Tags & Custom Fields** — pull data from posts, ACF, WooCommerce, authors, and more.
- **Theme Style & global design system, Custom CSS, Custom Fonts/Icons, Role Manager.**

1.3 Elementor Editor V3 vs. Editor V4 (Atomic Editor)

Since 2025, Elementor has been rolling out a new "V4" (Atomic) editor built around Classes, Variables and pure elements such as *Div Block*, *Flexbox*, *Heading*, *Paragraph*, *Button*, *Image*, *SVG* alongside a redesigned Style tab (Layout, Spacing, Size, Position, Typography, Background, Border, Effects). Most live sites still run on the classic V3 Sections/Columns/Containers model documented throughout this manual; V4-specific concepts are called out separately in Chapter 9 where relevant.

Who this manual is for: WordPress site builders, freelancers and marketing teams who want a single reference for every backend menu, every widget, and every settings panel available in Elementor Pro.

CHAPTER 2

Installation, Activation & License

2.1 System Requirements

Requirement	Recommended
WordPress	Latest stable release
PHP	7.4+ (8.0–8.3 recommended)
MySQL / MariaDB	5.6+ / 10.1+
Memory limit	256 MB+
Browser	Latest Chrome, Firefox, Safari or Edge

2.2 Installing Elementor (Free)

1. In WP Admin, go to [Plugins → Add New](#).
2. Search for "Elementor Website Builder" and click **Install Now**, then **Activate**.
3. A new **Elementor** item appears in the left-hand WP Admin menu.

2.3 Installing & Activating Elementor Pro

1. Purchase a plan and download the [elementor-pro.zip](#) file from your My Elementor account, or install directly via the built-in installer.
2. Go to [Plugins → Add New → Upload Plugin](#), choose the ZIP, click **Install Now**, then **Activate**.
3. A new menu item, [Elementor → License](#), appears. Paste your license key and click **Activate** to connect the site to your Elementor account and unlock Pro widgets and features.

Tip: Elementor Pro requires the free Elementor plugin to also be installed and active — Pro is an add-on, not a replacement.

2.4 License Management

Under [Elementor → License](#) you can view the connected plan, number of activations used, deactivate the license (to move it to another site), or reconnect your Elementor.com account. Each Pro plan tier permits activation on a set number of websites; staging sites can usually be cloned without consuming an extra activation.

2.5 Updating Elementor & Elementor Pro

Updates appear under **Dashboard → Updates** or **Plugins** like any WordPress plugin. Always back up your site before major version updates, and check the changelog for breaking changes to Containers, Experiments or deprecated widgets.

CHAPTER 3

Touring the Elementor Editor

3.1 Entering the Editor

Open any page or post and click **Edit with Elementor**, or create a new page and choose the Elementor editor. The classic WordPress admin bar is replaced with the Elementor canvas and a left-hand panel.

3.2 The Left Panel

Area	Purpose
Widgets Panel	Searchable library of all widgets, grouped into Basic, Pro, Site (Theme Elements), WooCommerce and Favorites categories. Drag a widget onto the canvas to add it.
Elementor Logo Menu	Saved Templates, Site Settings, Theme Builder, Popups, User Preferences, Notes, Finder, Keyboard Shortcuts, and Exit to WordPress.
Element Settings	When a widget/section/container is selected, this panel switches to its Content, Style and Advanced tabs.
Structure / Navigator	A collapsible tree view (bottom-left icon or Ctrl/Cmd+I) listing every section, container and widget for quick navigation, reordering and visibility toggles.

3.3 The Top Bar & Bottom Bar

- **Responsive Mode icons** — switch the live preview between Desktop, Tablet and Mobile breakpoints.
- **History** — full undo/redo action log, separate from browser undo.
- **Revisions** — WordPress-style autosave/revision history with restore.
- **Preview Changes** — opens the current draft in a new tab.
- **Publish / Update** — saves the page live.
- **Page Settings (gear icon)** — per-page Title, Status, Visibility, Featured Image, Page Layout template, and (Pro) custom CSS/scripts for that page only.

3.4 Working With the Canvas

Click the large "+" icon to add a new Section or Container. Drag widgets from the left panel directly onto the canvas; drop zones highlight where the element will land. Right-click any element for a context menu (Copy, Paste, Duplicate, Save as Template, Reset Style, Delete). Use **Ctrl/Cmd+C / V** to copy elements between pages, and drag the six-dot handle to reorder.

3.5 The Finder

Press **Ctrl/Cmd+E** anywhere in wp-admin or the editor to open the Finder — a searchable command palette to jump to any page, post, template, or Elementor settings screen instantly.

CHAPTER 4

The WordPress Backend: Elementor's Admin Menus

Once Elementor and Elementor Pro are active, a dedicated **Elementor** menu appears in the WordPress left sidebar. Here is what each item does.

Menu Item	What it does
Home	Dashboard overview: quick links to create a page, browse templates, and account/usage summary.
Templates → Saved Templates	Library of all reusable Section/Container/Page templates you've saved, with Insert, Export, and Delete actions.
Templates → Theme Builder PRO	Create and assign Header, Footer, Single Post, Single Page, Archive, Search Results, 404 and Product templates site-wide (see Chapter 10).
Templates → Popups PRO	Build and manage popups, hello bars, slide-ins and fly-ins with display/trigger conditions (see Chapter 11).
My Templates / Cloud Templates	Personal or account-wide template library synced across sites you manage.
Site Settings	Global Design System — Site Identity, Global Colors, Global Fonts, Theme Style, Layout, Background, Lightbox (see Chapter 15). Can also be opened from inside the editor via the hamburger menu.
Custom Fonts PRO	Upload and register self-hosted font files (WOFF/WOFF2/TTF) for use across the site.
Custom Icons PRO	Upload custom SVG icon sets so they appear alongside Font Awesome in every Icon control.
Custom Code PRO	Add HTML/CSS/JS snippets with placement (head/body) and display conditions, without editing theme files (see Chapter 16).
Role Manager PRO	Control which WordPress user roles can access Elementor and which controls/features they see (see Chapter 17).
Custom CSS PRO	Site-wide CSS editor (also available per-page and per-element).

Menu Item	What it does
Maintenance Mode	Put the site into Maintenance (503) or Coming Soon (200) mode, and choose which template displays to visitors (see Chapter 19).
Tools	Regenerate CSS/Data files, Sync Library, Rollback to a previous Elementor version, Safe Mode toggle, Version Control, Replace URL (for migrations), and Import/Export Kit.
Settings	General plugin settings — post types enabled for Elementor, default fonts/colors behavior, Google Maps API key, image sizes, and integrations (see Chapter 18).
Experiments / Features	Toggle beta and stable feature flags such as Containers, Flexbox Container, Optimized DOM Output, Nested Elements (see Chapter 18).
Role Manager, License, Connect & Upgrade	Account connection, license key activation, and upsell/upgrade prompts.
System Info	Full environment report (PHP/WP/server details, active plugins/theme) — used mainly when contacting support.
Get Help	Direct links to documentation, the Help Center, and submitting support tickets.

Note: Exact menu wording varies slightly between Elementor versions (e.g., some items are nested under "Templates" while newer versions surface Theme Builder and Popups as top-level items). The functionality described above remains consistent.

CHAPTER 5

Universal Widget Settings

Every widget in Elementor — free or Pro — shares the same three-tab settings structure. Learning this once means you already understand 80% of every widget's panel.

5.1 Content Tab

Unique to each widget: the actual text, images, links, source data, and behavioral options (e.g., number of columns in a gallery, autoplay for a slider). This is the only tab that differs meaningfully between widgets.

5.2 Style Tab

Visual controls that appear (in some combination) on almost every widget:

- **Typography** — font family, size, weight, line-height, letter-spacing, text transform (or a Global Font).
- **Color** — text/icon/background colors, with the option to pick a Global Color.
- **Background** — Classic (color/image/gradient), Gradient, or Video/Slideshow background with overlay controls.
- **Border & Border Radius** — style, width, color, and per-corner rounding.
- **Box Shadow / Text Shadow** — horizontal/vertical offset, blur, spread, color, inset toggle.
- **Alignment & Spacing** — text alignment, padding and margin (linked or per-side, with unit selector: px, %, em, rem, vw, vh).

5.3 Advanced Tab

Section	What it controls
Layout	Margin, Padding, per-widget z-index, and (in containers) width/flex-grow behavior.
Motion Effects	Entrance Animations, Scrolling Effects (vertical/horizontal scroll, transparency, blur, scale, rotate), Mouse Effects (3D tilt, mouse track), Sticky positioning.
Transform PRO	Rotate, Scale, Skew, Offset and Flip, independently for normal and hover states.
Background Overlay PRO	A second background layer above the base background — often used for gradient/color overlays on images.
Responsive	Hide on Desktop / Tablet / Mobile toggles, and per-device Z-index & visibility.

Section	What it controls
Custom CSS PRO	Element-scoped CSS using the <code>selector</code> keyword to target the widget's own wrapper.
Attributes PRO	Add custom HTML attributes (e.g. <code>data-*</code> , <code>aria-*</code>) to the widget's wrapper element.
Custom Positioning	Absolute/Fixed positioning with Top/Right/Bottom/Left offsets and Width.
Responsive Visibility	(Sections/Containers) show/hide entire structural blocks per device.
CSS ID / CSS Classes	Add a unique ID or one/more classes for styling or JS targeting.

5.4 Global Colors, Global Fonts & Global Widgets

Any color or typography control can be linked to a **Global Color** or **Global Font** defined in Site Settings — change it once, and it updates everywhere it's used. Elementor Pro additionally lets you convert any element into a **Global Widget**: edits to the master copy propagate to every instance placed across the site (useful for a shared CTA block or header banner).

5.5 Right-Click / Element Context Menu

- Edit, Duplicate, Copy, Paste, Paste Style, Reset Style
- Save as a (Section/Container/Column) Template
- Copy/Paste display conditions across elements
- Delete

CHAPTER 6

Layout Elements: Sections, Columns & Containers

6.1 Sections & Columns (Classic Layout)

The original Elementor layout model: a **Section** is a full-width horizontal wrapper; each Section holds one or more **Columns** side by side. Sections control background, height (min-height, full screen height), content width and structure (1–6 columns, or custom ratios). Columns control their own width %, vertical alignment, background, and padding. Nested "Inner Sections" allowed multi-row layouts inside a single column (a legacy technique now superseded by Containers).

6.2 Flexbox Containers

Containers replace Sections/Columns/Inner Sections with a single, nestable Flexbox element. Key Layout-tab settings:

- **Content Width** — Boxed or Full Width.
- **Direction** — Row or Column (and reverse variants).
- **Justify Content / Align Items / Align Content** — standard Flexbox alignment controls.
- **Wrap** — allow child elements to wrap onto new lines.
- **Gaps** — row/column gap between children.
- **Min Height** — including full viewport height option.

Containers can be nested infinitely, dragged and dropped directly into one another in the Navigator, and made clickable (turning the whole container into a link) — something Sections could not do.

6.3 Grid Containers

A Container set to **Grid** display exposes CSS Grid controls: number of columns/rows (or custom `grid-template` definitions), column/row gap, auto-flow direction, and per-child column/row span — ideal for magazine-style or card layouts without nested wrappers.

6.4 Choosing Between Sections and Containers

Aspect	Sections/Columns	Containers
Nesting	Limited (Section → Column → Inner Section)	Unlimited nesting of one element type

Aspect	Sections/Columns	Containers
Output markup	Heavier, more wrapper divs	Leaner, faster-rendering HTML
Layout engine	Custom Elementor grid	Native CSS Flexbox / Grid
Recommended for	Legacy sites / older templates	All new projects (Elementor's current default)

Tip: New sites should default to Containers — enable/confirm this under [Elementor → Settings → Features → Containers](#) if it isn't already the default in your version.

6.5 Other Structural Elements

Element	Use
Inner Section (Legacy)	Adds a nested row of columns inside a Column, for pre-Container layouts.
Menu Anchor	Invisible marker used as a jump-link target for one-page navigation.
Off-Canvas PRO	A slide-out panel (drawer) container triggered by a button/icon, used for mobile menus, filters or cart panels.

CHAPTER 7

Free Widget Reference (Basic Elementor)

These widgets are available in the free Elementor plugin and form the foundation of every page, even on Pro sites. All are found under the **Basic** and **General** categories of the widgets panel.

Widget	Usage & Key Content-Tab Options
Heading	Adds an H1–H6 (or <code>div/span</code>) headline. Options: text, HTML tag, size preset, alignment, link.
Text Editor	Rich-text (WYSIWYG) paragraph block, same editor as WordPress's classic editor — bold, lists, links, embedded media.
Image	Inserts a single responsive image with caption, link, custom sizing, and hover animation options.
Video	Embeds YouTube, Vimeo, Dailymotion, or a self-hosted video with autoplay, loop, mute, controls, lightbox and privacy-mode options.
Button	A styled call-to-action link. Options: text, link, size, icon (left/right), hover animation, button type/color presets.
Divider	A horizontal rule with style (solid/dashed/dotted), weight, width, color, and an optional centered icon/text.
Spacer	Adds vertical empty space between elements with a precise height value per breakpoint.
Image Box	Combines an image, heading, and description in one card — great for feature/service blocks.
Icon Box	Combines an icon, heading and text; icon position (top/left/right) and shape (circle/square/framed) configurable.
Icon List	A repeater list where each row has its own icon and text — ideal for feature lists or checklists.
Icon	A single standalone icon from Font Awesome (or a custom icon set), with shape, border and hover options.
Counter	An animated number that counts up on scroll — configure start/end number, duration, prefix/suffix.
Progress Bar	An animated horizontal bar showing a percentage — options for title, inner text, and display percentage.

Widget	Usage & Key Content-Tab Options
Testimonial	A single quote/review block with image, name, and title/company fields.
Tabs	Horizontal/vertical tabbed content panels; each tab has its own title and rich content area (repeater).
Accordion	Stacked, collapsible content panels, one (or several) open at a time; supports FAQ Schema markup.
Toggle	Similar to Accordion but each item toggles independently — often used for simple show/hide FAQs.
Social Icons	A repeater row of branded social network icons that link out to your profiles, with shape/color presets.
Alert	A dismissible colored notice box (info/success/warning/danger style) with title and description text.
HTML	A raw code box for pasting custom HTML/JS/embeds directly into the page.
Shortcode	Renders any WordPress shortcode (from another plugin) inside the Elementor layout.
Menu Anchor	An invisible anchor point that other links/buttons can jump to for one-page navigation.
Sidebar	Displays a registered WordPress widget-area/sidebar inside the page.
Google Maps	Embeds an interactive map at a given address/coordinates with zoom-level control.
SoundCloud	Embeds a SoundCloud track or playlist player by URL.
Read More	Inserts a manual "read more" break inside Post Content on archive/blog listings.
Rating / Star Rating	A static star-rating display (choose scale and number of stars) for reviews or ratings.
Basic Gallery	A responsive grid of images with lightbox support, columns, and spacing controls.
Image Carousel	A sliding carousel of images with navigation arrows/dots, autoplay, and slides-to-show settings.
Basic Media Carousel	Combines image and video slides in a single lightweight carousel.
Text Path	Bends text along a custom SVG path shape for decorative headlines.
Search Form / Search	A functional site search box, standalone or as a results-triggering icon/overlay.

Tip: Use the widget panel's search bar (top of the left panel) and type a widget name to jump straight to it instead of scrolling categories.

CHAPTER 8

Elementor Pro Widget Reference — General & Marketing

These widgets unlock once Elementor Pro is active and licensed. They appear in the widgets panel under "Pro."

Widget	Usage & Key Options
Animated Headline	A headline where one word/phrase animates (rotate, typing, highlight, etc.) — great for dynamic hero titles.
Blockquote	A styled quotation block with several skin/layout presets and optional attribution and social-share icon.
Call to Action	A full promo card combining image/background, headline, description, ribbon badge and button in one widget with hover animations.
Carousel	A flexible content carousel (built on Swiper) that can hold any nested widgets per slide, not just images.
Code Highlight	Displays syntax-highlighted code snippets with language selection and a copy button.
Countdown	A live countdown timer (to a date, or a recurring/evergreen timer) — commonly used in popups for urgency offers.
Facebook Comments	Embeds the native Facebook comments plugin for a page/post.
Facebook Embed	Embeds a specific public Facebook post or video by URL.
Facebook Like Button	Embeds Facebook's Like/Share button widget.
Facebook Page Feed	Displays a live feed/timeline from a connected Facebook Page.
Flip Box	A two-sided card that flips on hover/click to reveal secondary content — image or icon on the front, text/CTA on the back.
Form	The full drag-and-drop form builder: field types (text, email, select, checkbox, upload, date, etc.), multi-step, validation, and Actions After Submit. See Chapter 12.
Atomic Form Element	The newer V4/Atomic-editor version of the Form widget, using Classes/Variables styling.

Widget	Usage & Key Options
Global Widget	Not a distinct widget type, but a mode: any widget/section saved as "Global" syncs edits across every page it's placed on.
Hotspot	Places clickable animated dots/tooltips over an image for interactive product or infographic call-outs.
Link in Bio	A pre-built, mobile-style "link tree" landing-page block combining avatar, bio, and stacked link buttons.
Login	An inline WordPress login/registration/lost-password form styled to match the page.
Loop Grid	A dynamic, filterable grid pulling from any post type/taxonomy/query, rendered using a chosen Loop Item template. See §8.1.
Loop Carousel	Same querying engine as Loop Grid, displayed as a sliding carousel.
Lottie	Plays a Lottie (JSON) vector animation, with scroll/hover/click triggers and loop/reverse controls.
Media Carousel	A slider mixing images/videos with optional caption overlay, thumbnail navigation, and Ken Burns effect.
WordPress Menu (Nav Menu)	Renders any WordPress-registered navigation menu with layout (horizontal/vertical/dropdown), breakpoint control and mobile "hamburger" toggle.
Paypal Button	A ready-made PayPal "Buy Now" checkout button (no cart) for a fixed price item.
Stripe Button	A ready-made Stripe checkout button for one-off payments.
Portfolio	A filterable project/case-study grid with category filtering and lightbox/link-through on click.
Price List	A repeater-based menu/price list (e.g., restaurant menu) pairing item name, description, price and optional image.
Price Table	A pricing-plan card: price, period, feature list, ribbon badge, and CTA button — for subscription/plan comparisons.
Progress Tracker	A visual multi-step progress indicator (e.g., checkout steps) tied to scroll position or manual step values.
Reviews	Displays structured customer/product reviews with schema markup for rich snippets.
Share Buttons	A row of social sharing icons (Facebook, X/Twitter, LinkedIn, Pinterest, WhatsApp, email, etc.) for the current page.

Widget	Usage & Key Options
Slides	A full-screen, section-replacing slideshow with background image/video per slide, heading, text and CTA.
Table of Contents	Auto-generates a jump-link outline from a page's headings, with sticky/collapsible display options.
Template	Inserts any saved Elementor template (section/page) by reference — reuse the same block across many pages.
Testimonial Carousel	A sliding version of the Testimonial widget for multiple reviews in one rotating block.
Video Playlist	A main video player paired with a clickable thumbnail playlist sidebar — for course or tutorial pages.

8.1 Loop Grid / Loop Carousel & Loop Item Templates

Loop widgets are Elementor Pro's dynamic-query engine. Workflow:

1. Drag a **Loop Grid** (or **Loop Carousel**) widget onto the page.
2. Choose the source: Posts, Pages, Products, or any custom post type.
3. Design (or pick) a **Loop Item** template — a mini-template representing one repeated card, using Dynamic Tags for the title, image, excerpt, etc.
4. Set the **Query** (Content Tab → Query) — include/exclude terms, post count, offset, order, and "related to current post" logic.
5. Add pagination and, optionally, front-end filters via the Taxonomy Filter widget.

CHAPTER 9

Elementor Pro Widget Reference — Theme Elements

"Theme Elements" widgets pull dynamic, per-page data automatically (the current post's title, the current author, site logo, etc.). They're designed to be used inside Theme Builder templates (Header, Footer, Single Post, Archive) but can be dropped onto any page too.

Widget	Usage & Key Options
Site Logo	Pulls the logo set in Site Identity ; supports a separate logo for sticky/mobile headers.
Site Title	Outputs the site name/tagline set in WordPress General Settings as editable text.
Page Title	Outputs the current page/post's title automatically wherever the template is used.
Post Title	Same as Page Title but specifically for blog posts inside Single Post / Archive templates.
Breadcrumbs	Auto-generated "Home > Category > Page" trail with separator and Home-link customization.
Post Content	Renders the full post/page body content (from the WordPress editor) inside a custom Single template.
Post Excerpt	Shows the auto/manual excerpt with configurable length and "Read More" link, typically used on archive cards.
Post Info	A flexible meta-data row: author, date, comment count, terms/categories, reading time — choose which to show and their icons/order.
Post Navigation	Previous/Next post links at the bottom of a Single Post template.
Post Comments	Renders the native WordPress comment form and comment thread.
Author Box	Displays the post author's avatar, name, bio, and social links; pulls from the WP user profile.
Archive Posts	Auto-renders the correct list of posts for whatever archive context the template is assigned to (category, tag, date, author), without manual querying.
Posts	A manually configured post grid/list (choose post type, taxonomy, order, layout) for use on any page, not tied to the current archive context.
Sitemap	Outputs a full HTML sitemap of pages/posts/categories directly on a page.

Widget	Usage & Key Options
Search Form	The Theme-Elements version of the search box, styled to match header/footer templates.
Menu Cart 	A shopping-cart icon with live item count and mini-cart dropdown/off-canvas panel — for the header.
Taxonomy Filter	Front-end filter buttons/dropdowns that narrow a Loop Grid/Carousel by category or custom taxonomy without reloading the page.

Note: Several Theme Elements widgets only display real data inside an actual Theme Builder context (e.g., a Single Post template) — dropped onto a normal static page, "Post Title" or "Post Content" will simply reflect that page's own data.

9.1 Elementor Editor V4 (Atomic) Elements

Sites running the newer Editor V4 replace several classic widgets with lighter "elements" governed by reusable **Classes** and **Variables** instead of per-widget style copies:

Element	Classic equivalent
Div Block	Section / Container
Flexbox	Flexbox Container
Heading	Heading widget
Paragraph	Text Editor widget
Button	Button widget
Image	Image widget
SVG	Icon widget
YouTube	Video widget (YouTube source)
Tabs (Atomic)	Tabs widget

V4's Style tab is split into dedicated panels — Layout, Spacing, Size, Position, Typography, Background, Border, Effects — each writing to reusable Classes managed centrally in the Class Manager, plus a global Variables Manager for colors, fonts and sizing tokens.

CHAPTER 10

Theme Builder

The Theme Builder is Elementor Pro's tool for designing the parts of a site that surround your content — the pieces every WordPress theme normally hard-codes in PHP. Access it at

[Elementor → Theme Builder](#) or via the editor's hamburger menu.

10.1 Template Types

Template Type	Purpose
Header	Site-wide top navigation bar: logo, menu, search, cart icon, CTA button. Can be made sticky or transparent-over-hero.
Footer	Site-wide bottom area: widgets, links, copyright, social icons, newsletter signup.
Single Post	The layout wrapping every blog post — combine Post Title, Post Info, Featured Image, Post Content, Author Box, Post Navigation and Post Comments widgets.
Single Page	An equivalent wrapper template for regular Pages.
Single (Custom Post Type)	The same concept applied to any custom post type registered on the site (e.g., "Team Members," "Events").
Archive	Blog/category/tag/date/author listing pages, typically built around the Archive Posts widget.
Search Results	Customizes the layout of the WordPress search-results page.
404 Page	A custom "Page Not Found" template — often includes a Search Form and navigation links.
Product Archive woo	WooCommerce shop/category listing pages.
Single Product woo	The individual WooCommerce product page layout.

10.2 Creating a Template

1. Go to [Theme Builder → Add New](#), pick the template type, name it, and click **Create Template**.
2. Design it in the normal Elementor editor using Theme Elements widgets (Chapter 9) plus any other widget.
3. Click **Publish**. You'll be prompted to set **Display Conditions**.

10.3 Display Conditions

Conditions decide where a template applies, evaluated by specificity (most specific wins over a broader rule):

- **Entire Site** — applies everywhere unless overridden.
- **Singular / Archive / Search Results / 404** — broad content-type rules.
- **Specific post type, category, tag, or individual post/page** — narrow, targeted rules (e.g., "Single Post → Category → Announcements").
- **Include / Exclude** — each condition can add or subtract from the match.

You can create multiple Header or Footer templates for different sections of a site (e.g., a distinct header for a WooCommerce shop vs. the main marketing pages) by layering conditions with different specificity.

10.4 Theme Style (Global Defaults)

Under **Site Settings → Theme Style**, set sitewide default typography and colors for un-styled HTML elements — H1–H6, paragraph text, links, buttons, form fields and images — so new content is on-brand without manual styling on every widget.

Tip: Build one Header and one Footer template first, set its condition to "Entire Site," and every page/post immediately inherits them — no need to touch individual pages.

CHAPTER 11

Popup Builder

Found at [Elementor → Popups](#), this tool builds and controls any overlay content — modal popups, hello bars, slide-ins, and fly-ins — using the same editor as regular pages.

11.1 Popup Layout Types

Type	Typical use
Classic Opt-in	Centered modal box — email capture, promotions, announcements.
Full Screen	Covers the entire viewport — age gates, welcome mats, cookie/GDPR notices.
Hello Bar	Thin bar fixed to the top of the page — sitewide announcements or promo codes.
Bottom Bar	Same concept fixed to the bottom of the viewport.
Slide-In	Small box that slides in from a screen edge — subtle newsletter or chat prompts.
Fly-In	A floating box that animates in from a chosen direction and position on the page.

11.2 Building a Popup

1. [Templates → Popups → Add New](#), choose a layout type or start blank.
2. Design content with any widget — Form, Countdown, Image, Button are the most common.
3. Open **Popup Settings** (gear icon) to set width/position, overlay color, entrance/exit animation, and close-button style.
4. Configure the **Advanced** tab: timing delay, frequency (e.g., once per session/day), and whether closing sets a cookie to suppress re-display.

11.3 Trigger Conditions

Trigger	Behavior
On Page Load	Opens after a configurable delay when the page loads.
On Scroll	Opens once the visitor scrolls past a percentage of the page, or to a specific element.

Trigger	Behavior
On Click	Bound to a specific button/link (via the element's Advanced → Popup settings, or a dedicated "Popup" link action).
Exit Intent	Fires when the cursor moves toward the browser's close/tab bar (desktop only).
Inactivity	Opens after N seconds without visitor interaction.
After Page Views	Opens once a visitor has viewed a set number of pages in the session.
On Specific Date/Time	Active only within a scheduled date range.

11.4 Display Conditions & Targeting

Just like Theme Builder templates, popups use **Display Conditions** to decide which pages they can appear on (Entire Site, specific pages/posts, categories, or WooCommerce shop pages). Combine with **User role / logged-in status** targeting under Advanced Rules to show different popups to guests vs. members.

11.5 Common Recipes

- **Newsletter opt-in** — Classic layout + Form widget + exit-intent trigger + "once per 7 days" frequency.
- **Cookie consent** — Bottom Bar + Accept/Decline buttons + "On Page Load, no delay" + a Custom Code snippet or the dedicated Cookie Consent tool to store consent.
- **Content lock** — Full Screen popup triggered "On Scroll" past a point, requiring form submission before the close button appears.
- **Cart reminder** — Popup opened from the Menu Cart or Add to Cart action, showing a WooCommerce Cart widget.

CHAPTER 12

Forms: Building, Actions After Submit & Submissions

12.1 Field Types

Field	Notes
Text / Textarea	Single or multi-line free text, with placeholder and character-limit options.
Email / URL / Tel / Number	Built-in format validation for each data type.
Select / Radio / Checkbox	Predefined option lists; supports custom values distinct from display labels.
Date / Time	Native date/time pickers with format and min/max range options.
Acceptance	A single required checkbox (e.g., "I agree to the Terms") — commonly linked to a Privacy Policy page.
Upload	File attachment field with allowed file types and max size.
Hidden	Passes a fixed or dynamic value (e.g., page URL, UTM parameter) without displaying a field.
reCAPTCHA / hCaptcha	Spam-prevention challenge, invisible or checkbox style.
Step	Divides the form into multiple pages with a progress bar (Multi-Step Forms).

12.2 Form Content Tab Structure

1. **Form Fields** — the repeater list above; drag to reorder, set required/width/column-span per field.
2. **Form Name** — internal label used to distinguish multiple forms in Submissions and email notifications.
3. **Buttons** — Submit button text, size, alignment, and (for multi-step) Next/Previous labels.
4. **Actions After Submit** — see §12.3.

12.3 Actions After Submit

Action	Effect
Email	Sends notification(s) to one or more addresses; a separate "Email 2" action can send an auto-reply to the submitter.
Webhook	Posts the submission as JSON to any external URL — the universal integration method.
Redirect	Sends the visitor to a URL (e.g., a thank-you page) after submission.
Collect Submissions	Stores entries in Elementor → Submissions inside WP Admin.
Popup / Open a Popup	Opens a chosen popup (e.g., a "Thank You" modal) immediately after submit.

Action	Effect
Mailchimp / ActiveCampaign / HubSpot / GetResponse / ConvertKit / Drip / AWeber / MailerLite / MailPoet	Native connectors that push the submission into the corresponding email/CRM list mapping form fields to service fields.
Zapier	Sends data to a Zap for onward automation in thousands of other apps.
Slack / Discord	Posts a formatted notification into a channel via webhook.

Multiple actions can run from a single submission (e.g., Email + Collect Submissions + Mailchimp + Redirect all at once).

12.4 Managing Submissions

Under **Elementor → Submissions** (also called "Form Submissions"), view, search, filter by form/date, export to CSV, resend notification emails, or delete entries — a lightweight built-in CRM inbox.

12.5 Spam Protection & Troubleshooting

- Add a reCAPTCHA v2/v3 field and set your site/secret key under **Elementor → Settings → Integrations**.
- Use the HoneyPot option (Advanced tab) as a lightweight secondary spam trap.
- If a form shows "Invalid Form" or "not visible for site visitors" — check that required fields have valid names and that no ad-blocker/security plugin is stripping the AJAX request.

CHAPTER 13

WooCommerce Builder & Product Widgets

With WooCommerce active alongside Elementor Pro, the Theme Builder gains two more template types (Product Archive and Single Product — see §10.1), and a dedicated set of WooCommerce widgets appears in the panel.

13.1 Single Product Widgets

Widget	Maps to
Product Title	The product's name/H1.
Product Images	Main gallery with thumbnail navigation and zoom/lightbox.
Product Price	Regular/sale price display, honoring active discounts.
Product Rating	Star rating and review count summary.
Short Description	The product excerpt shown near the Add to Cart button.
Product Content	The full long-form product description.
Add to Cart	Quantity selector, variation dropdowns, and the Add to Cart button.
Custom Add to Cart	A freely-styled Add to Cart button usable anywhere (not just the single product template).
Product Meta	SKU, categories and tags row.
Product Stock	In-stock/out-of-stock/backorder status text.
Product Data Tabs	Description / Additional Information / Reviews tab group.
Additional Information	Attribute/specification table.
Upsell / Related Products	Cross-sell grids shown below the main product.
Breadcrumbs (WooCommerce)	Category-aware breadcrumb trail for shop pages.

13.2 Archive / Shop Widgets

Widget	Purpose
Products / Products Archive	Grid of products for the shop or a category archive, with columns, pagination and sorting controls.
Archive Description	Category/tag description text pulled from WooCommerce taxonomy settings.
Archive Title	Auto-generated "Shop," category, or tag heading.
Product Categories	A visual grid/list of shop categories with images and product counts.
Menu Cart	Header cart icon with live count and dropdown/off-canvas mini-cart (see §9).
Cart	Full cart-page layout: line items, quantity editing, coupon field, cart totals.
Checkout	Full checkout-page layout: billing/shipping fields, payment methods, order review.
My Account	Customer account dashboard — orders, addresses, downloads, account details, logout.
Notice	Styles WooCommerce's system notices (added to cart, errors, coupon messages).
Purchase Summary	Condensed order-summary block, often used on custom checkout/upsell flows.

13.3 Configuring WooCommerce Site Settings

Under **Elementor → Settings** or **Site Settings → WooCommerce**, control: number of products per row/page on archives, default sale-badge and out-of-stock styling, and whether Elementor or WooCommerce's own theme templates render the shop pages.

Tip: Build the Single Product template once with Display Condition "All Products," then override for a specific category (e.g., "Digital Downloads") with a second, more specific template if it needs a different layout.

CHAPTER 14

Dynamic Tags

Dynamic Tags let a control (text, image, link, color...) pull its value from a live data source instead of a hard-coded entry — the mechanism that makes Theme Builder templates and Loop Grids actually "dynamic." Click the small database/circle icon next to a supported control to open the Dynamic Tags menu.

14.1 Dynamic Tag Categories

Category	Example tags
Post	Title, Excerpt, Content, Featured Image, Post URL, Post ID, Date/Time, Comments Count, Terms/Taxonomy, Custom Field (ACF/Meta), Shortcode.
Site	Site Logo, Site Title, Site Tagline, Site URL.
Archive	Archive Title, Archive Description, Archive URL/Meta.
Author	Author Name, Author Bio, Author Profile Picture, Author Meta, Author Custom Field.
Media	Featured Image, Media File (from a custom field), Placeholder image fallback.
User	Current User's info (name, avatar, email) — for logged-in personalization.
Comments	Comments Number, Comments URL.
WooCommerce	Product Price, SKU, Stock, Rating, Attribute, Add to Cart URL, and more.
Request Parameter	Reads a value from the page's URL query string (e.g., <code>?ref=</code>) directly into a widget.
Actions (Pro)	Dynamic Contact URL / Smart Link tags — auto-build <code>tel:</code> , <code>mailto:</code> , or WhatsApp links from a custom field value.

14.2 Using a Dynamic Tag

1. Click the dynamic-tag icon beside a compatible field.
2. Pick a tag from the category list (search is available for large sites).
3. Configure the tag's own mini-settings (e.g., excerpt length, date format, fallback text if empty).
4. The field now displays a live preview and updates automatically for every post/product the template is applied to.

14.3 Dynamic Colors & Dynamic Lightbox

Dynamic Colors let a Color control read its value from a custom field (e.g., a category's brand-color meta field) instead of a fixed swatch. **Dynamic Lightbox** settings let an image or gallery's lightbox behavior (caption source, type) also be data-driven.

14.4 ACF & Custom Fields Integration

If Advanced Custom Fields (or native post meta) is installed, its fields appear automatically inside the relevant Dynamic Tag category (usually "Post → Custom Field" or "Author → Custom Field"), letting Loop Items and Single templates surface any custom data without code.

CHAPTER 15

Site Settings (Global Design System)

Open via **Elementor** → **Site Settings** in WP Admin, or the hamburger menu inside the editor. This is the single source of truth for sitewide branding.

Panel	Controls
Site Identity	Site name, description, site logo (+ optional inverted/sticky logo), and favicon.
Global Colors	4 default brand colors (Primary, Secondary, Text, Accent) plus any number of custom named colors, reused everywhere via the color picker's "Global" tab.
Global Fonts	Default Primary/Secondary/Text/Accent typography sets (family, size, weight) plus custom named font styles, reused the same way as Global Colors.
Theme Style	Default styling for raw HTML elements site-wide: Headings (H1-H6), Body/paragraph text, Links (normal/hover), Buttons, Images (default border-radius, spacing), and Form Fields.
Layout	Default content width (boxed container size in px), Space Between Widgets (default vertical gap), page layout (with/without sidebar), and breakpoints for Tablet/Mobile (Pro allows fully custom breakpoints, including Mobile Extra/Widescreen).
Lightbox	Global on/off, background color/opacity, UI color, and toggles for the image title/description caption and share/zoom icons in the lightbox popup.
Background	A sitewide default background (color/image) rendered behind all page content.
WooCommerce	(If WooCommerce is active) default shop-page product columns/rows, sale badge text, and related-products display.

15.1 Global Colors & Fonts in Practice

Any Color or Typography control across every widget has a small circle icon to switch between a one-off value and a linked Global value. Rebranding a site is then a matter of editing four color swatches and two font sets in Site Settings, instantly updating every element that references them.

15.2 Variables Manager (Editor V4)

On sites using Editor V4, Global Colors/Fonts are superseded by a unified **Variables Manager**: define color, font, and size tokens once, then bind any Style-tab property to a variable. Variables (and Classes) can be exported/imported as a design-system JSON file to replicate branding across projects.

15.3 Global Custom CSS

Under **Elementor** → **Custom Code** → **Custom CSS** (or Site Settings → Custom CSS on some versions), write raw CSS that applies across the entire site — useful for small global tweaks that don't warrant a child theme stylesheet.

CHAPTER 16

Custom Code, Custom Fonts & Custom Icons

16.1 Custom Code

Under **Elementor → Custom Code**, add unlimited HTML/CSS/JS snippets without editing theme files or installing a separate code-snippets plugin.

Setting	Details
Code	Freeform code editor (accepts full <code><script></code> / <code><style></code> tags or bare JS/CSS).
Location	Header, Body – Start, or Body – End.
Display Conditions	Same engine as Theme Builder/Popups — target Entire Site, specific pages/posts, post types, or archives.
Priority	A numeric load-order value when multiple snippets target the same location.
Status	Active/Inactive toggle to disable a snippet without deleting it.

Typical uses: Google Analytics/Tag Manager, Facebook Pixel, custom fonts via `@font-face`, third-party chat widgets, and small JS behavior tweaks.

16.2 Custom Fonts

Under **Elementor → Custom Fonts**, upload self-hosted font files (WOFF2, WOFF, TTF, EOT, SVG) as a named Font Family. Once added, the family appears in every Typography control's font-family dropdown alongside Google/System fonts — useful for licensed brand fonts that can't be pulled from Google Fonts, or for GDPR-conscious local font hosting.

16.3 Custom Icons

Under **Elementor → Custom Icons**, upload a ZIP of SVG icons (following Elementor's icon-set folder structure) to register a custom icon library. The set then appears as its own tab inside every Icon control throughout the plugin, alongside the built-in Font Awesome library — ideal for using a brand's proprietary icon set consistently.

16.4 Custom Attributes & Custom CSS on Individual Elements

Beyond global code, every element's **Advanced tab** offers element-scoped versions: **Custom CSS** (styles scoped to that widget using the `selector` keyword) and **Attributes** (arbitrary `key|value` pairs added to the rendered HTML tag, useful for tracking attributes or ARIA labels).

CHAPTER 17

Role Manager & User Permissions

Found at [Elementor → Role Manager](#), this screen controls what each WordPress user role can see and do inside the Elementor editor — essential when handing a site to a client or non-technical editor.

17.1 What Can Be Restricted

- **Access to the Elementor Editor itself** — allow or block a role from entering "Edit with Elementor" entirely.
- **Access to Site Settings** — hide global design controls from editors who shouldn't change brand colors/fonts.
- **Access to individual widget categories or specific widgets** — e.g., allow only Text, Image and Button, hiding Custom Code/HTML from non-developers.
- **Access to specific controls within a widget** — fine-grained hiding (for example, allow editing text but not the underlying layout structure).

17.2 Configuring a Role

1. Open [Elementor → Role Manager](#).
2. Select a WordPress role (Administrator, Editor, Author, Contributor, or any custom role from another plugin).
3. Toggle access to Site Settings, and expand each widget category to check/uncheck individual widgets that role may use.
4. Save Changes — restrictions apply immediately, hiding the corresponding items from that role's widget panel.

17.3 Related: Limit Access to Elements

A complementary feature (under [Elementor → Settings](#) or as its own "Limit Access to Elements" screen in newer versions) lets you globally disable specific widgets or features site-wide for performance/security reasons, separate from per-role restrictions.

Tip: Combine Role Manager with the Element Manager (Chapter 18) — Role Manager controls *who* sees a widget; Element Manager controls whether it's loaded/available *at all*.

CHAPTER 18

Elementor Settings, Experiments & Performance

18.1 General Settings

Under **Elementor → Settings → General**:

- **Post Types** — which content types (Post, Page, custom post types) can be edited with Elementor.
- **Default Generic Fonts** and **Disable Default Colors/Fonts** — control whether Elementor's own baseline styling loads (disable when a theme's own design system should take over).
- **Google Maps Embed API Key** — required for the Google Maps widget to function without usage limits/errors.
- **Enhanced Elementor Asset Loading** and **CSS Print Method (Internal Embedding vs External File)** — affects caching and performance.
- **Usage Data Sharing** — opt in/out of anonymous analytics sent to Elementor.

18.2 Integrations Settings

Under **Elementor → Settings → Integrations**, add API keys/credentials for reCAPTCHA, hCaptcha, Facebook SDK, TypeKit/Adobe Fonts, and any connected marketing service used by Forms.

18.3 Advanced Settings

Toggle Google Fonts loading location (local vs. Google CDN, for GDPR), enable/disable the Improved Asset Loading and Improved CSS Loading performance modes, and configure the editor's default breakpoints.

18.4 Experiments / Features

Under **Elementor → Settings → Experiments**, individual features can be set to Inactive / Active / Active by Default as they mature from beta to stable. Notable flags include:

Experiment	What it changes
Flexbox Container	Enables/enforces the Container element described in Chapter 6, replacing Sections/Columns for new content.

Experiment	What it changes
Optimized DOM Output	Removes unnecessary wrapper <code><div></code> s from the rendered HTML for cleaner markup and faster paint.
Optimized Gutenberg Loading	Prevents Gutenberg's block-editor assets from loading on pages that only use Elementor.
Improved Asset Loading / Improved CSS Loading	Loads only the CSS/JS actually required by widgets present on the page.
Nested Elements	Allows widgets like Tabs and Accordion to contain full nested Containers instead of fixed text-only content areas.
Element Caching	Caches the rendered output of dynamic widgets (e.g., Loop Grid) to reduce database queries on repeat views.
Additional Custom Breakpoints	Unlocks Mobile Extra Large and Widescreen breakpoints beyond the default three.

18.5 Element Manager

Under **Elementor → Element Manager**, see every widget (core + third-party) with a live usage count across the site, and disable ones that are never used to shrink the widgets panel and reduce loaded assets.

18.6 Tools Menu

Tool	Use
Regenerate CSS & Data	Clears and rebuilds Elementor's cached CSS files — fixes most "my styling isn't showing" issues.
Sync Library	Refreshes the connection to the online Template Library.
Version Control / Rollback	Reverts to a previous Elementor (or Elementor Pro) version if an update causes conflicts.
Safe Mode	Loads the editor with all other plugins/theme functions disabled, to isolate a conflict.
Replace URL	Bulk find-and-replace a domain across all saved Elementor content — used after a site migration.
Import / Export Kit	Package Site Settings, templates and content into a portable Kit file (or the reverse) to move a design between sites.

Tool	Use
Maintenance Mode	See Chapter 19.

18.7 Performance Best Practices

- Prefer Containers over legacy Sections/Columns for lighter markup.
- Enable Optimized DOM Output, Improved Asset/CSS Loading experiments.
- Turn on Lazy Loading for below-the-fold images and background images.
- Use Element Caching for Loop Grid/Carousel-heavy pages.
- Disable unused widgets via Element Manager.
- Pair with a caching plugin/CDN and compressed images (Elementor Image Optimizer add-on if available).

CHAPTER 19

Maintenance Mode & Coming Soon

Found at [Elementor → Tools → Maintenance Mode](#) (or its own top-level menu item in some versions), this feature shows a single page to visitors while you build or update the rest of the site.

19.1 Modes

Mode	Behavior
Disabled	Normal site behavior — the default state.
Coming Soon	Returns HTTP 200 (OK) — search engines can still index the page; used pre-launch to build hype without hurting SEO once the real site goes live.
Maintenance	Returns HTTP 503 (Service Unavailable) — tells search engines the downtime is temporary, appropriate for short live-site maintenance windows.

19.2 Configuration

- **Choose Template** — select any saved Elementor template/page to act as the maintenance screen (build one with a countdown, logo and email signup for a "coming soon" launch page).
- **Who Can Access** — Logged in users only, or additionally allow specific IP addresses or roles to preview the live site while others see the maintenance page.

Note: Administrators are always able to browse the real site while Maintenance/Coming Soon mode is active for everyone else.

CHAPTER 20

Troubleshooting Quick Reference

Symptom	First things to try
Styling changes don't appear on the live site	Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data; then clear any caching plugin/CDN cache.
Editor stuck on loading screen / blank	Enable Safe Mode; check the browser console for JS errors (a theme/plugin conflict is the usual cause).
Pro widgets are greyed out / can't drag	Confirm the Pro license is activated under Elementor → License; ensure both Elementor and Elementor Pro are updated to compatible versions.
Form shows "Invalid Form" or spam errors	Re-check required-field names, reCAPTCHA keys under Settings → Integrations, and any security/ad-block plugin blocking the AJAX endpoint.
Header/Footer missing on the front end	Verify the Theme Builder template is Published (not just saved as draft) and its Display Condition actually matches the page.
Custom fonts/CSS not showing live	Confirm the Custom Code/Font snippet's Status is Active and its Display Condition includes the page in question.
500 / 502 / white screen after an update	Increase PHP memory limit, enable WP_DEBUG to view the exact error, or use Version Control to roll back to the previous Elementor release.
Mobile layout looks broken	Check Responsive Visibility per widget, verify custom breakpoints under Site Settings → Layout, and preview each breakpoint individually in the editor.
A widget is missing from the panel	Check it hasn't been disabled in Element Manager or restricted for the current user's role in Role Manager.

20.1 Where to Get Further Help

- **Elementor Help Center** — searchable knowledge base at elementor.com/help.
- **Elementor → Get Help / Priority Support** — direct ticket submission for Pro subscribers.
- **System Info** ([Elementor → System Info](#)) — copy this report when contacting support so they see your exact environment.

End of manual. Keep this document alongside your site's own style guide — Elementor evolves quickly, so always cross-check menu wording against your installed version and the official Help Center for the very latest changes.